whom Providence sends, in the hour of a nation's trouble, to reconduct it into those paths of peace and toleration which alone can assure the happiness of millions.' See Malleson, *Akbar and the Rise of the Mughal Empire*.

Meanwhile, Vincent A. Smith has this to say: 'Akbar regarded the assertion of independence by any ruling prince within the reach of his arm as a personal affront to be expiated by ruthless conquest.' See Vincent A. Smith, *Akbar the Great Mogul, 1542–1605* (Clarendon Press, 1917).

. 'The Happy Sayings of His Majesty', in Abu'l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 3, trans. Col. H.S. Jarrett (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

.See Talbot, 'Justifying Defeat: A Rajput Perspective on the Age of Akbar'.

. Ibid.

. Lt-Col. James Tod, *Annals and Antiquities of Rajasthan, or the Central and Western Rajput States of India*, vol. 2 (Higginbotham & Co., 1880).

. Norman P. Ziegler, 'Some Notes on Rajput Loyalties during the Mughal Period', in *The Mughal State: 1526–1750*, eds Muzaffar Alam and Sanjay Subrahmanyam (Oxford University Press, 1998). It is from this 'chakar', presumably, that we get the commonly used Hindustani term, *naukar-chakar*.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. It was around this time, too, that Baz Bahadur – a decade after he lost his kingdom and his beloved Rupmati to Adham Khan and Pir Muhammad's unsparing attack, having spent long years seeking shelter and alliances, once even with the Rana of Mewar – decided there was nothing for it but to join Akbar's court.

. Rajasthan, as Norman P. Ziegler describes it, was not a rich land of itself, being 'a relatively isolated frontier region of marginal agricultural importance'. It was, however, 'a strategic transitional zone situated between larger cultural centres in Gujarat and on the north Indian plain, criss-crossed by trade routes running between these larger centres'.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.